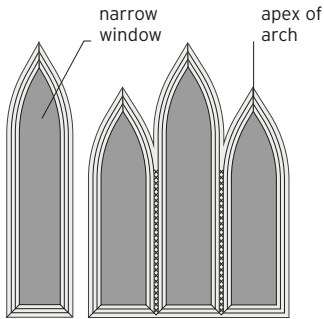


L

LANCET ▼ A tall, narrow window with a sharp, pointed arch at its apex.



LANTERN An element on a roof or the top of a dome or tower that allows natural light into the room or space below.

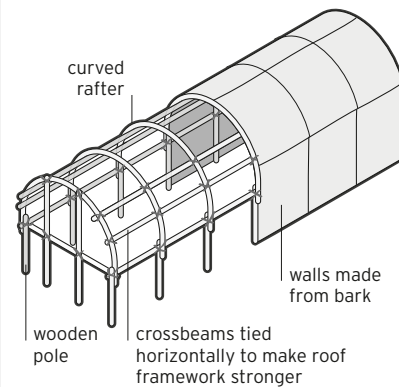
LATIN CROSS A cross in which the horizontal element is shorter than the vertical and the two elements intersect high up on the vertical. It resembles the cross on which, in Christian tradition, Jesus Christ was crucified. *See also* Greek cross.

LIME A mineral used in the production of mortar, cement, and concrete. Its use dates back to ancient times.

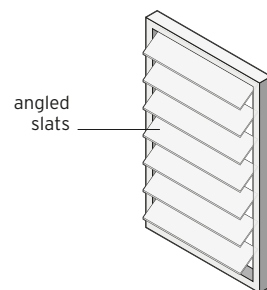
LINTEL A horizontal block that spans the space between two vertical supports. Lintels are commonly found over doors and windows.

LOGGIA A covered corridor or gallery on the exterior of a building, open to the elements on one side and usually supported on columns or arches.

LONGHOUSE ▼ A long, narrow dwelling, typically wooden-framed, common to many ancient cultures and some contemporary indigenous cultures, notably some of the inhabitants of Borneo.



LOUVRE ▼ A shutter with horizontal slats angled to admit light and ventilation but to keep out rain and direct sunshine.



LUNETTE A small, semicircular section of wall, usually over a door or window—for example, on the

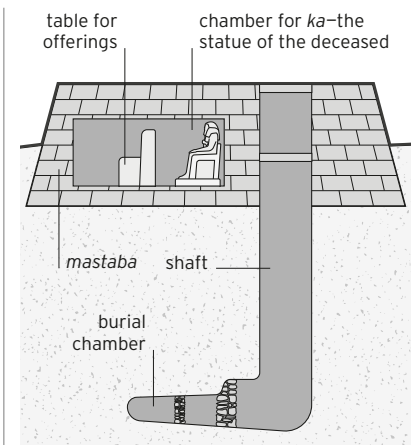
end wall of a barrel-vaulted room. It may contain a mural, sculpture, or another window.

M

MADRASA Also spelled *madrasah*, an Islamic theological school or college. Some buildings serve a double function as a mosque-madrasa. There is no particular architectural form associated with a *madrasa*, but historically it can be lavishly decorated.

MANNERISM An architectural style originating in 16th-century Italy as a reaction against the harmony and forms of the High Renaissance. It is characterized by the distortion of proportions and arbitrary arrangements of decorative features. For example, the colossal order has its origins in Mannerism. *See also* Renaissance architecture.

MANSARD A type of roof associated with France that is characterized by having two slopes on each of its sides; the lower slope has steep sides and is typically punctured by dormer windows, while the upper slope is shallower. It is also known as a gambrel roof. *See also* dormer, roof.



MASTABA ▲ A type of early ancient Egyptian tomb that takes the form of a simple low, flat, rectangular structure with inward-sloping sides.

MEGALITH A large stone erected, mainly in the Neolithic period, as a monument or as part of a monument with other stones. *See also* monolith.

MEZZANINE An intermediate floor in a building that does not extend over the whole space of the floor below and so, in part, overlooks the lower floor.

MIHRAB A small niche or alcove in the wall of a mosque that indicates the direction of prayer. *See also* mosque.

MINARET *See* panel, below.

MODERNISM An architectural style that emerged in the 1930s, associated with functionality,

MINARET

In Islamic societies, the muezzin calls the neighborhood to prayer five times a day. To allow his voice to carry as far as possible, the call would traditionally be made from the top of a minaret, or tower. The architectural styles of minarets have varied by region and era. Even today, when the call to prayer is broadcast via loudspeakers, mosques maintain the tradition of the minaret.

